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Making Use of Study Time

At one point in time, college students have procrastinated. Whether it be completing the minuscule assignment or the big term paper, most people are inclined to want to do other things, so the schoolwork gets set aside. Study time does not only include studying for tests and quizzes, but also includes homework and writing of papers. It is important to note, though, that by waiting until the last minute, the quality of the work tends to be less than that if the assignment was spaced out. To make the best use of study time, one should plan their time accordingly, maintain discipline, and minimize distractions.

First of all, one should plan assignments and tasks so that an allotted amount of time can be used to work on each. Each task should have its own reasonable time slot in which work can be completed. For example, one should not allow fifteen minutes for a term paper, or a three hours for a homework assignment of ten questions. By prioritizing assignments, the most important tasks are given the most time to complete, while menial tasks are given less time. One should also leave extra time in the case that the time allotted for the task was too small.

There are different ways in which one could keep oneself organized. The old fashioned way would be to write down plans on a sheet of paper. This can be done, but is not very efficient. A superior counterpart can also be considered. For the computer savvy, an electronic scheduling system is very helpful, like Microsoft Outlook, a free alternative like Mozilla Sunbird, or a portable device, such as a PDA, with a scheduling program installed. The advantages of using a computer program is that it can check for overlapping times and remind

oneself of an upcoming task. By choosing a technique to keep organized, one can keep on track with the tasks at hand.

To maintain discipline, one should focus on at the task at hand. To do that, one should be consistent with the study time. Having a break in between assignments is a good idea, but when the time comes to work on an assignment, that task must be given one's undivided attention. It is also important to step back and take a deep breath if one gets stressed out from all of the work. Instead of thinking about all of the work as one task, think about the work as different tasks, and this may help to alleviate some stress.

Finally, after one has a planned schedule on how to complete the work, one should try to minimize the distractions as little as possible. It does not matter if one has a planned schedule. If one cannot focus on the task at hand, then the schedule will be altered each time a distraction is encountered. The easiest way to prevent this is to avoid the distractions in the first place. One should turn off the television, radio, or computer to avoid common distractions. Another good idea is to not do homework on the computer, as the computer may easily tempt one into playing games or browse the internet; rather, do homework on paper if necessary. Not only entertainment distractions can occur, but human distractions can happen also. It is best to tell people that may be around to not be distractive, including family and friends. If family and friends will not cooperate, then find another place to study, such as a library. Eliminating distractions is essential in completing that very important task.

One mistake many people make is to not seek help when it is needed. Certain people may struggle in a specific subject, yet may not want to find help. This can be a bad idea as it means that the individual will not have a full understanding of the topic or assignment, and may make horrible grades. If one is embarrassed about not knowing the material, one could ask a friend who understands the material well. One could also go to a tutoring session, which many

Buchanan 3

colleges and schools have available.

In conclusion, taking steps to ensure one can complete tasks will not only get the work done, but increase the finished quality of the work. By dividing the tasks up into smaller subtasks, the work load will seem less stressful, as well as it will be more manageable. Using this information, even the most daunting tasks can be accomplished.